

FILM FESTIVAL

The Eternal Hero



Sixty years of Navketan, a banner that continues to make movies, is no easy feat in changeable Bollywood. Dev Anand, its architect, may now be peripheral to the film industry's fortunes, but he gave it much of its contemporary outlook. From Waheeda Rehman's free-spirited Rosy in Vijay Anand's

Guide (1965) to the very ordinary Mangal in Chetan Anand's *Taxi Driver* (1954), Anand broke several stereotypes, aided by his supremely talented filmmaker brothers. Influenced deeply by Hollywood and yet retaining his unique visual style. At 86, he continues to act and direct. The Directorate of Film Festivals marks the anniversary with a three-day festival between September 4 and 6, at Siri Fort Auditorium-2, Delhi.

by Kaveree Bamzai

FESTIVAL

Steps and BEATS

Natya Tarangini presents Aradhanam, a festival of dance and music; September 4-6 in Delhi, featuring gurus and their disciples on the same platform.

The Malladi brothers, Sreeram Prasad, 32, and Ravi Kumar, 36, are the fresh faces among the younger generation in Carnatic music. They have vibrant voices and a balance in their singing.

THE MALLADI BROTHERS



The nephew, 36, of Guru Hariprasad Chaurasia is taking the legacy forward. Rakesh's technique coupled with his training in rhythm makes the bamboo flute extremely haunting.

RAKESH CHAURASIA



Neena Prasad, 28, was attracted to the Mohiniattam due to its sensuality. A disciple of Kalamandalam Kshemavathi and Kalamandalam Sugandhi, Prasad's dance is sheer grace and has lyrical quality.

by S. Sahaya
Ranjit

NEENA
PRASAD



FILM REVIEW

SIKANDAR

Tedious Goodness

RATING ★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆

Director: Piyush Jha
Starring: Parzan Dastur, Ayesha Kapur, Sanjay Suri

Some films are better as anthropology than as cinema. *Sikandar* is a young orphan, one of the countless

victims of violence in Kashmir. He loves football but hates school where he is constantly bullied by three particularly obnoxious creatures. Until one day he discovers a gun. Expectedly there are clichés on *aman* and *azadi*. There is the stereotyping of the *fauj* as perpetrators of senseless violence and of the terrorists as permanently scruffy men blindly committed to their cause. What makes *Sikandar* somewhat different is that there is no

Pakistani foreign hand anywhere around. The politicians of Kashmir, the ones who run for elections and the ones who safeguard the cause of Islam, are shown as the culprits who cannot take a stand. It's a strong comment to make and it's a pity Piyush Jha is not a more accomplished storyteller. He tends to lean on crutches, intersecting each significant scene with a shot of a mist coloured mountain, and segmenting each episode of horrific violence with a "lighter" sequence of *Sikandar* engaging playfully with his classmate Nasreen. Their laughter, ringing loudly over the intermittent shots of exploding bombs and rat-atat gunfire, is meant to remind us of the innocence of childhood but it feels more like the leaden weight of good intentions strangling the life out of a good idea.

by Kaveree Bamzai

